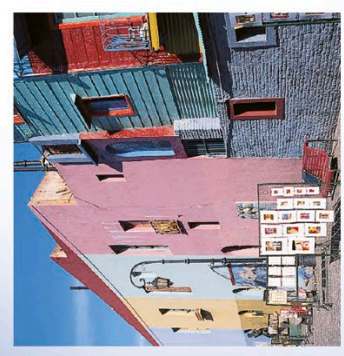




DANCING THE TANGO
Popular around the world today, the tango originated in the slums of Buenos Aires in the late 1800s. This passionate dance with its characteristic rhythm is accompanied by music on a type of concertina known as a *bandoneón*, together with piano and violin.

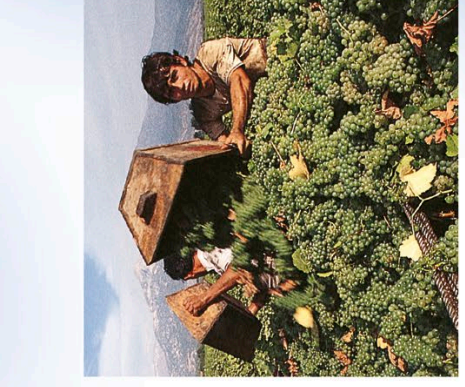
Chile has a large concentration of astronomical observatories because of its exceptionally clear skies.



BUENOS AIRES
More than one-third of Argentina's population lives in or around the capital Buenos Aires. A thriving port on the River Plate estuary, it is the largest city in Argentina. The colorful La Boca district with its painted walls is home to the descendants of Italian immigrants.



Gaucho herding cattle in the Pampas region



WINES FROM CHILE
About 90 percent of Chileans live in the central region, where the rich soil is ideal for a wide range of agriculture. Vines were brought to Chile by the Spaniards, and the country now has an important wine-making industry that exports wine all over the world.



ANDES MOUNTAIN WEATHER
The Andes stretch the entire length of South America, and this has a major effect on the weather. As westerly air from the Pacific Ocean rises over the mountains, its moisture can fall as rain and snow. By the time it reaches the eastern side, the air is much drier and the landscape is more arid.



PAMPAS
Vast, treeless plains called the Pampas—which means “flat” in Spanish—cover much of southern and western Argentina. The Pampas are used to grow cereals and raise cattle. *Gauchos*, Argentinian cowboys, work on large ranches, or *estancias*.

